

The Principles Catalog (3–5 Core Principles)

Draft a small set of foundational Enterprise and Architecture Principles. Each principle must follow the strict TOGAF template: **Name**, **Statement**, **Rationale**, and **Implications**.

The Standard TOGAF 4-Part Template

1. **Name:** A short, memorable, and unambiguous title (it should not mention specific product or vendor names).
2. **Statement:** A concise, clear, and unambiguous declaration of the fundamental rule.
3. **Rationale:** The business justification for why this principle is important and what benefits it brings, using business terminology.
4. **Implications:** The practical impact on both the business and IT (in terms of costs, resource allocation, and tasks). This answers the critical question: *"How does this affect me?"*

Principle 1:

Student-Owned Session Records

Statement: Undergraduate students are the primary recorders of their own mentoring sessions, and the mentoring unit validates rather than encodes these records.

Rationale: Starting AY 2026-2027, the university requires three mentoring sessions per semester for all undergraduates who are now responsible for logging these sessions. With only two operations coordinators, the mentoring unit cannot sustain manual encoding for the entire undergraduate population. Placing the duty of recording sessions to the students themselves also increases timeliness and accountability.

Implications:

- Any logging tool must be simple enough for students to use without assistance.
- The mentoring unit's role shifts from data entry to monitoring, validation, and follow-up of incomplete records.
- Students and mentors need clear guidance on what counts as a valid session.
- A mechanism is needed to flag students who fall below the required number of sessions before the semester ends.

Principle 2:

Data Consistency and Accuracy

Statement: All data about mentor-mentee pairings and session logging must be consistent and complete across all parties that maintain it.

Rationale: The Mentoring Unit is not the sole owner of this data—it is being used by the other parties for their own monitoring and approval purposes. Schools manage their own records of mentees and mentors, ManCom relies on it to answer institutional questions, and the IT Office relies on it to determine the effectiveness and compliance of their tools. Inconsistent or inaccurate data between each of these parties undermines trust in reporting and makes it difficult to determine if students are indeed meeting their required number of sessions each semester.

Implications:

- Any change in a process must include a way to reconcile data between the Unit's records and each of the school's own records. This is not just cleaning up the Unit's own system in isolation
- The database for the Google Forms session logging and the mentor-mentee pairing are isolated from one another. This is a consistency risk, despite sharing similar data, and must be minimized and not treated as a permanent setup.
- There are possible discrepancies in the reporting in the old logging process. This may be apparent in the new policy and must be eliminated, investigated, or at least minimized.

Principle 3:

Google Workspace as Primary Operations Tool

Statement: Solutions for the mentoring unit use the university's existing Google Workspace services before any new application or platform is considered.

Rationale: The mentoring unit currently runs all its operations on Google Workspace, which the university already licenses and the IT office already supports. The staff are familiar with these tools. It was mentioned that a dedicated mentoring portal was abandoned, which shows the risk of introducing systems the unit cannot maintain on its own.

Implications:

- New requirements are first assessed against Forms, Sheets, Drive, Calendar, and Apps Script.
- A non-Workspace solution requires a documented justification and an endorsement from the IT office.
- The solution inherits Workspace's limits on access control, automation, and reporting.

Principle 4:

Confidentiality of The Mentoring Relationship

Statement: Mentor-mentee assignments, mentor-change reasons, and discussions in mentoring sessions must remain confidential and not be disclosed beyond what is necessary to process them.

Rationale: In accordance with the university's data privacy policies and Philippine law, personal information must be strictly handled confidentially. This is to protect identity and safety of the people involved.

Implications:

- All information that will be handled in this engagement must be handled confidentially and not released publicly.
- Proposal of processes that will handle personal information must be disclosed to all parties involved.
- Processes that will handle these personal information must be in compliance with the university's data privacy policies and Philippine law.

Principle 5:

Minimal Additional Burden on Staff

Statement: Any proposed process or tool change must not increase the Mentoring Unit's workload or headcount beyond the two staff.

Rationale: The Mentoring Unit staff size is extremely limited. This constraint must be worked around and must not increase the burden on them to retain operational efficiency.

Implications:

- Proposed processes or tool change must be simple to implement or use as to not increase the work burden to the unit and all other parties involved.
- Proposed processes or tool must improve the existing processes or replace them to meet the enterprise needs and goals.

Request for Architecture Work

Enterprise: Mentoring Unit, Center for Student Affairs (CSA), University of Asia and the Pacific

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Date: September 2026

Sponsor and Requesting Organization

The sponsor of this request is Ms. Maria Concha De La Cruz, Executive Director of the CSA, who holds approval authority over changes to the mentoring program and reports mentoring updates to the Management Committee (ManCom). The requesting organization is the mentoring unit, represented by its Operations Coordinators, Ms. Nina and Ms. Kellai, who manage the program's daily operations.

Mission of the Organization

No formal mission statement was provided. Based on the stakeholder interview, the mission is derived as follows: to support the holistic formation of UA&P students through a structured mentoring program that pairs each student with a qualified mentor. The mentoring unit is distinct from the Office of Guidance and Counseling, which focuses on student mental health.

Business Goals and Change Driver

On August 7, 2026, the University announced a new institutional policy, effective the first semester of AY 2026-27, requiring every undergraduate student to complete three mentoring sessions per semester. Students who do not comply are placed on follow-up status, and two consecutive semesters on follow-up may affect their eligibility to enroll. The policy also transfers the responsibility for logging sessions from mentors to students. In response, the unit aims to achieve the following:

- ensure complete and accurate session records for all undergraduate students;
- keep its records consistent with those held by the schools;
- provide data that answers ManCom's questions on program compliance;
- notify students and mentors of their assignments in a timely manner.

Strategic Plans and Time Limits

The work follows the academic semester cycle. Students are expected to hold their first session within September and to complete all required sessions before the semester ends. Any architecture recommendations should be usable within the current academic year, while the new policy is still in its initial implementation.

Current Business System and Architecture

Students currently log sessions through a Google Form. An Apps Script sends each submission to the named mentor by email for confirmation, and the mentor's response updates the linked Google Sheet. The mentoring unit also monitors confirmations through a separate administrative email account, since several parties share access to

the Sheet. The mentoring unit previously used a dedicated Mentoring Portal, in which mentors logged sessions. That arrangement was replaced this academic year by the student-submitted Google Form. The program serves approximately 1,500 to 1,600 undergraduate students and about 180 faculty mentors, together with a group of external mentors.

Organizational Constraints

The mentoring unit has two staff members, who handle monitoring, communication, and record reconciliation for the entire undergraduate population. The pairing of students with mentors is performed by each school's mentoring coordinators and lies outside the division's control. Pairing turnaround and mentor changes are therefore treated as external dependencies, not as targets for redesign.

External Constraints

The work is bound by the University's mentoring policy and its governance structure. Changes require approval from the Executive Director, and drastic changes require ManCom approval. Mentor assignments are confidential, and the content of sessions is not recorded. The handling of student data must comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 and applicable University policies. The division also depends on the following units:

- the schools, for pairing and school-level records;
- the IT Office, for the maintenance of the Form and script;
- Human Resources, for external mentor contracts;
- Financial Management and Resources, for external mentor allowances.

Budget Information

No dedicated budget has been identified for this work. It is assumed that any proposed solution will use existing University resources, principally the Google Workspace license and IT Office support. Any proposal requiring new expenditure would be subject to approval by the Executive Director and, where applicable, ManCom.

Developing Organization and Available Resources

The architecture work will be performed by the Student Architecture Team as part of the IT Elective: Solution Architecture course. Available resources include the stakeholder interview conducted on September 11, 2026, the institutional mentoring policy, access to the mentoring unit's operations coordinators, and the Google Workspace tools currently in use.

Scope of the Requested Work

This request covers the TOGAF Preliminary Phase for the mentoring unit. The work will establish the architecture boundary, stakeholder map, tailored metamodel and content framework, and architecture principles. The boundary includes the division and its direct interfaces with the schools' coordinators, the IT Office, the Registrar, Human Resources, Financial Management and Resources, and the governance chain to ManCom. Junior College and graduate programs, as well as the redesign of school-side pairing, are outside the scope of this request.